GEOGRAPHY

🏙️ LIVEABILITY

READ What makes a place liveable?

Liveability describes how suitable a place is for people to live. A highly liveable place usually provides people with safe housing, access to services, opportunities for work and education, and a healthy environment. However, liveability is not exactly the same for everyone. What one person considers important may be less important to someone else.

Geographers often examine several factors when comparing the liveability of places. Housing includes whether people can find safe and affordable homes. Access to services includes schools, hospitals, shops and other facilities. Transport considers whether people can travel easily and safely to work, school and other places.

The environment can also affect liveability. Clean air and water, green spaces, parks and pleasant public places can make a neighbourhood more enjoyable. On the other hand, pollution, overcrowding and a lack of green space may reduce liveability.

Other factors include employment, safety, recreation and community connections. A place with many jobs may attract people, while good public transport can make it easier for residents to reach those jobs. Parks, sporting facilities, libraries and cultural activities can provide opportunities for people to relax and connect with others.

Because liveability involves many different factors, geographers sometimes use liveability indicators to compare places. These indicators provide information about particular features of a place. It is important to remember that an overall score does not tell the whole story: different people may experience the same place in different ways.

🏠 Housing	🚌 Transport	🏥 Services	🌳 Environment
safe homes	roads & public transport	schools & hospitals	parks & clean air

1 Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
liveability	A. a feature used to measure or compare a place
indicator	B. how suitable a place is for people to live
services	C. places and facilities people use, such as schools and hospitals
recreation	D. activities people do for enjoyment or relaxation

2 Comprehension

a. What does the word liveability mean?

b. Name two things that can make housing more liveable.

c. Give three examples of services mentioned in the text.

d. How can public transport improve liveability?

e. Name two environmental features that can improve liveability.

3 True or False

1. Liveability is exactly the same for everyone. True / False

2. Access to schools and hospitals can affect liveability. True / False

3. Pollution can reduce liveability. True / False

4. Liveability only depends on the environment. True / False

5. An overall liveability score tells the complete story of a place. True / False

4 Reading between the lines

a. Why might a person with a low income have a different view of liveability from a wealthy person?

b. Why could good public transport improve several areas of liveability at the same time?

c. The text says that an overall score does not tell the whole story. What does this mean?

5 Sort the factors

Place each factor under the heading where it fits best. Some factors could fit more than one category.

HOUSING & SERVICES	ENVIRONMENT	TRANSPORT & CONNECTIONS
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Factors: clean air • affordable homes • buses and trains • hospitals • parks • safe roads • schools • green spaces

6 Apply your knowledge

Imagine two suburbs:

Suburb A has affordable housing, frequent buses, a hospital and several parks, but very little employment nearby.

Suburb B has many jobs and shops, but expensive housing, heavy traffic and very few green spaces.

a. Which suburb might be more liveable for a family that needs affordable housing and parks? Explain.

_____

_____

b. Which suburb might be more attractive to someone who wants to live close to employment? Explain.

_____

_____

c. Give one improvement that could increase the liveability of Suburb A and one improvement for Suburb B.

_____

_____

7 Extended response

Write a paragraph answering: What are the most important factors that make a place liveable? Use evidence from the reading and explain your ideas. Aim for 100–120 words.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

LIVEABILITY — WORKSHEET 2

READ: A day in two different places

Morning in Greenfield begins with a short walk to a nearby bus stop. The streets are quiet and there are trees along the footpaths. A local primary school, medical centre and supermarket are all within a few kilometres. The suburb has several parks, but there are not many jobs nearby, so many adults travel to another part of the city for work.

Morning in Riverton is busier. The suburb has many shops, offices and factories, so there are plenty of local jobs. However, housing is expensive and traffic is often heavy. There are buses and trains, but they can become crowded during peak times. Riverton has only a few small parks and some areas have poor air quality because of traffic.

Which place is more liveable? There is no single answer. Greenfield may be more attractive to someone who values quiet streets, parks and affordable housing. Riverton may appeal to someone who wants to live close to employment and shops. Geographers compare places by examining several liveability factors rather than relying on one feature.

Making places better can involve many strategies. A council might improve public transport, build affordable housing, create more green spaces or improve access to services. Residents can also have different priorities, so planners need to consider the needs of the community when making decisions.

FACTOR	GREENFIELD	RIVERTON
Jobs	few nearby jobs	many local jobs
Environment	trees, parks, quiet	traffic, fewer parks

1 Vocabulary in context

Term	Your meaning
liveability	_____
priority	_____
affordable	_____
strategy	_____

2 Comprehension — Find the evidence

a. Give two features that make Greenfield liveable.

b. Give two features that may reduce liveability in Riverton.

c. Why do many adults in Greenfield travel to another part of the city?

d. Why might Riverton appeal to a person who wants to work locally?

e. Name two strategies a council could use to improve liveability.

3 Choose the best answer

1. Which statement best describes liveability?

A. How large a city is
B. How suitable a place is for people to live
C. How many buildings a city has
D. How old a suburb is

2. Which feature is most directly connected to access to services?

A. A nearby hospital
B. A mountain range
C. A climate zone
D. A coastline

3. Which problem could reduce Riverton's environmental liveability?

A. Local jobs
B. Heavy traffic and poor air quality
C. Shops
D. Train access

4. Why is there no single answer about which suburb is more liveable?

A. Liveability is impossible to measure
B. All suburbs are identical
C. People have different needs and priorities
D. Jobs never matter

4 True, False or Not stated

1. Greenfield has more local jobs than Riverton. True / False / Not stated

2. Greenfield has several parks. True / False / Not stated

3. Riverton has no public transport. True / False / Not stated

4. Housing is expensive in Riverton. True / False / Not stated

5. Everyone would prefer to live in Greenfield. True / False / Not stated

5 Compare the places

a. Which suburb would you choose to live in? Give two reasons using evidence from the text.

_____

_____

_____

b. Identify one advantage and one disadvantage of each suburb.

_____

_____

_____

6 Think like a geographer

A city council has money for ONE major improvement. It can build affordable housing, improve public transport, create a large new park, or improve local health services. Which option would you choose? Explain why it would improve liveability.

_____

_____

_____

_____

7 Extended response

Write 120–150 words: ‘Liveability depends on more than just how a place looks.’ Do you agree? Use examples from Greenfield and Riverton.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

YEAR 7 GEOGRAPHY

Name: _____

Date: _____

LANDSCAPES & LANDFORMS

A **landscape** is an area of land as seen from a place.

A **landform** is a natural feature of the Earth's surface.

Landscapes include **natural features** (created by nature) and **human features** (made by people).



MOUNTAINOUS LANDSCAPE

COASTAL LANDSCAPE

A. UNDERSTAND THE TEXT

Read the short passage and answer the questions.

Landforms are created and changed by natural processes. **Weathering** breaks rocks down into smaller pieces. **Erosion** moves rock and sediment from one place to another. Water, wind, ice and waves can all cause erosion. Common landforms include mountains, valleys, plains, plateaus, rivers, waterfalls, beaches, cliffs, caves and sand dunes. People use landscapes for many reasons, such as farming, tourism, transport and building towns and cities.

B. LANDFORMS – WHAT ARE THEY?

Label each landform using the words in the box.

mountain	valley	plain	plateau	cliff
beach	river	waterfall	sand dune	cave



C. ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

1. What is a landscage?

   _____

   _____

2. What is a landform?

   _____

   _____

3. Name TWO natural features that can be found in a landscape.

   a. _____

   b. _____

4. What process breaks rocks down into smaller pieces?

   _____

5. What moves rock and sediment from one place to another?

   _____

D. MULTIPLE CHOICE

Circle the correct answer.

1. Which of the following can cause erosion?

   A. Water B. Wind C. Ice D. All of the above

2. Which of the following is a human feature?

   A. River B. Forest C. Road D. Mountain

3. Plains are...

   A. high areas of flat land.
   B. low areas between hills or mountains.
   C. large areas of mostly flat land.
   D. steep rocky coasts.

4. People use landscapes for...

   A. only farming.
   B. tourism, transport, building towns and cities.
   C. nothing.
   D. only looking at the views.

E. THINKING QUESTIONS

1. How might a mountainous landscape be different from a coastal landscape?

   _____

   _____

2. Why do you think landscapes change over time?

   _____

   _____

CHALLENGE!

Choose one landform from section B. Explain how it might have been formed or changed by natural processes.

Landform: _____

_____

_____

_____

F. SORT IT OUT!

Look at the pictures below. Write N for natural feature or H for human feature.



N = Natural feature

H = Human feature

Name: _____ Date: _____



VOLCANOES

READING & COMPREHENSION

Read the text carefully.

Deep beneath Earth's surface, temperatures are extremely high. Rocks can melt and form a hot, liquid material called **magma**. Magma is less dense than the solid rock around it, so it can slowly move upwards through cracks in Earth's crust.

When magma reaches the surface, it is called **lava**. If enough pressure builds beneath a volcano, an **eruption** can occur. During an eruption, a volcano may release lava, ash, rocks and gases into the atmosphere.

Some volcanic eruptions are relatively gentle. Lava may flow slowly down the sides of the volcano, giving people more time to move away. Other eruptions can be **explosive**. Large amounts of ash, rock and gases can be blasted high into the atmosphere.

Volcanic eruptions can be dangerous, but volcanoes can also have positive effects. Over time, volcanic ash and lava can break down and create soils that are rich in **nutrients**. These soils can be excellent for growing crops.

Volcanoes can also create new land. When lava cools and hardens, it becomes solid rock. After many eruptions, layers of rock can build up and form new mountains or even islands.



1 Vocabulary

Match each word with its correct meaning.

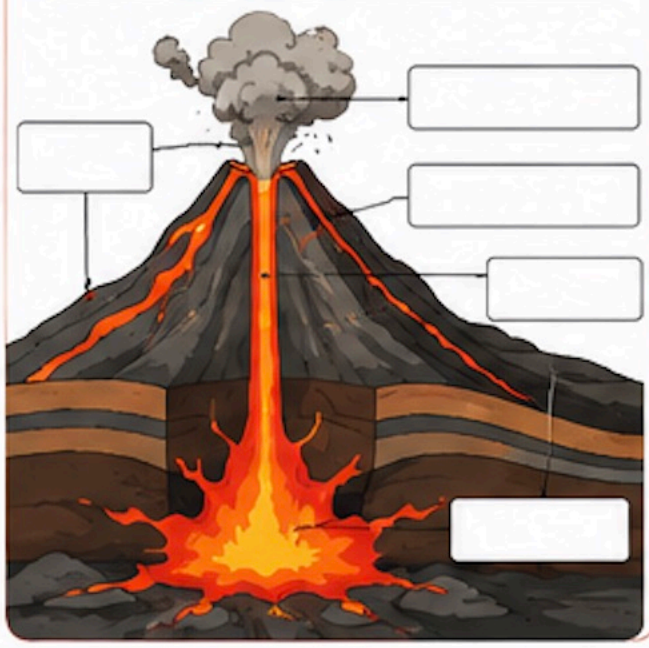
1. magma •	A. material that comes out of a volcano
2. lava •	B. a mixture of gases and tiny particles released during an eruption
3. eruption •	C. melted rock beneath Earth's surface
4. ash •	D. when a volcano releases material
5. nutrients •	E. substances that help plants grow

Answers: 1.___ 2.___ 3.___ 4.___ 5.___

2 Label the Diagram

Label the parts of the volcano using the words below.

ash cloud · crater · lava · main vent · magma chamber · layers of ash and lava



Name: _____ Date: _____

3 Find the Information

Answer in complete sentences.

a. What is magma?

_____

_____

b. Why does magma move upwards?

_____

_____

c. What is magma called when it reaches Earth's surface?

_____

d. Name three things that can be released during an eruption.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

e. How can volcanoes help farmers?

_____

_____

4 True or False?

Circle True or False for each statement.

1. Magma is found beneath Earth's surface. True / False
2. Lava is the name for magma beneath Earth's surface. True / False
3. All volcanic eruptions are explosive. True / False
4. Volcanic ash can help create fertile soil. True / False
5. Lava can create new land when it cools. True / False

5 Reading Between the Lines

Use information from the text to explain your thinking.

a. Why might people living near a volcano be concerned when pressure begins building beneath it?

_____

_____

_____

b. What does the text suggest about volcanoes – are they only dangerous? Explain your answer.

_____

_____

_____

6 Put It in Order

Number these events from 1–5 in the correct order.

- ☐ Lava cools and hardens.
- ☐ Magma forms beneath Earth's surface.
- ☐ A volcano may erupt.
- ☐ Magma moves towards the surface.
- ☐ New rock or land can form.

7 Writing Challenge – News Report

Imagine you are a journalist who has just witnessed a volcanic eruption.
Write a short news report of about 100–150 words.
Include: a headline • what happened • what the volcano released • how people reacted.
Use at least 3 volcanic vocabulary words and some descriptive language.

Headline: _____

_____



_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

DON'T FORGET!

- Use your best spelling and punctuation.
- Start with an interesting headline.
- End with a strong concluding sentence.